Title: The Chapter I'm In

Most people get their quirks from about age 19 to age 21; some can bend light, while others can talk to animals. My quirk arrived on my 20th birthday - "A Book"- A sleek, brown diary with my name embossed in gold. Inside it said,

"This book writes time."

There was a rule scribbled faintly on the last page—almost like a warning:
"*Each time you travel, your age in the present increases by the total number of years you move through****."***
For instance, traveling 10 years into the past and then returning causes an increase of 20 years in present age.

I hated my present life. Everything felt like, it was falling apart—people, plans, peace. So, without hesitation, I wrote, "*Take me 7 years into the past*."

Suddenly, I was 13 again—back in the warmth of my childhood home. I changed things. I stood up, when I used to stay silent. I hugged the ones I lost. I tried to make it better.
But, reliving every heartbreak and sadness only reopened wounds, I thought I'd buried.
And when I finally returned… I was 14 years older than, I should've been.
Still, the present felt unfamiliar. Heavy. So, I tried the future.

"Take me 10 years ahead."

It was bright, polished, and utterly cold. The people I loved, were distant or simply gone.
My future self-had everything I thought, I wanted—success, stability, even recognition — but none of it felt like *me*.
The small choices I avoided, the time I didn't value — it all added up to a life that looked perfect… but felt empty.
Everyone had changed. Or maybe I had.

For the first time, I wanted *now*. Not the past. Not the future.

So, I returned to the present — aged, tired, but awake. I couldn't undo the years I traded, but I could still write new pages.

And maybe, just maybe… the real quirk wasn't the book.
It was learning to live in the chapter I was in.

--Shaik Azra